

Stage 0 — Pre-Launch Foundation

Timing: 0–1 month | Objective: Make Shopiva operationally ready for a controlled launch

Primary task

Turn the existing product into a measurable, supportable marketplace rather than simply a published app.

Product & engineering

- Stabilize registration, product discovery, cart, checkout, checkout_intent, payment initialization, payment confirmation, order creation, shipping, notifications and account management.
- Define the transaction state machine: cart → checkout intent → payment → order → fulfillment → delivery → completion/refund/dispute.
- Make payment and order creation idempotent so webhook retries cannot create duplicate transactions.
- Instrument the funnel: product view, add-to-cart, checkout started, payment initialized, payment successful, order created, delivered, refunded and repeated purchase.
- Prepare production monitoring, error logging, backups, database migrations and incident procedures.

Marketplace operations

- Define vendor onboarding, verification, product-quality requirements, payout rules, cancellations, refunds and dispute handling.
- Document shipping zones, delivery partners, expected delivery windows and who pays each shipping cost.
- Prepare customer support channels and escalation rules.

Business readiness

- Finalize commission/take-rate, escrow fee, vendor terms, refund policy, privacy policy and terms of service.
- Define the initial geographic and customer segment instead of launching indiscriminately across Nigeria.
- Recruit an initial group of vendors and prepare their product catalogs before opening broadly.

Lean Startup application

- Treat the launch as an experiment designed to generate validated learning, not as proof that the business model is already correct.
- Define the riskiest assumptions before launch: who buys, what they buy, why they trust Shopiva, whether vendors remain active and whether the economics can work.
- Build only the measurement and product capabilities required to test those assumptions.

Exit criteria

- A stranger can discover a product, pay, receive an order and obtain support without founder intervention at every step.
- Critical business events are measurable.
- Initial vendors are onboarded and ready.
- Known payment, fulfillment and refund failure paths have been tested.

Founder question: What is the smallest controlled experiment that can prove whether people will complete a real transaction on Shopiva?

Framework reference: Eric Ries, *The Lean Startup* (Crown Business, 2011). This roadmap applies Lean Startup concepts such as validated learning, the Build–Measure–Learn loop, minimum viable product (MVP), innovation accounting, and pivot/persevere decisions. It does not reproduce the book's text.